

Solve a radical. ex. $\sqrt{x-1} + 2 = 5$.

1. Get the radical by itself,

$$\begin{aligned}\sqrt{x-1} + 2 &= 5 \\ \sqrt{x-1} &= 3\end{aligned}$$

2. Use a square root, simplify, and solve.

$$\begin{aligned}(\sqrt{x-1})^2 &= 3^2 \\ x-1 &= 9 \\ x &= 10\end{aligned}$$

3. Check! $\sqrt{10-1} = 9\checkmark$

Solve an equation with rational exponents. ex. $(x-7)^{3/2} - 64 = 0$.

1. Get the exponent by itself.

$$(x-7)^{3/2} = 64.$$

2. Get rid of the exponent, using the rule $(b^n)^m = b^{nm}$. Raise both sides by the reciprocal of the exponent ("flip it").

$$\begin{aligned}\left((x-7)^{3/2}\right)^{2/3} &= (64)^{2/3} \\ x-7 &= 64^{2/3} \\ x &= 16+7 \\ x &= 23\end{aligned}$$

3. Check. $(23-7)^{3/2} = 64\checkmark$

Solve the absolute value or indicate that it has no solution. ex. $|x+2| - 2 = 10$

1. Get the absolute value by itself.

$$\begin{aligned}|x+2| - 2 &= 10 \\ |x+2| &= 12\end{aligned}$$

2. Solve for + and -.

$$\begin{aligned}x+2 &= -12 & \text{and} & & x+2 &= 12 \\ x &= -14 & & & x &= 10\end{aligned}$$

3. Check! $|-14+2| - 2 = 10\checkmark$ and $|10+2| - 2 = 10\checkmark$

Solve by factoring. ex. $75x - 25 = 3x^3 - x^2$

1. Set the equation equal to 0 and write in descending order.

$$-3x^3 + x^2 + 75x - 25 = 0$$

2. Factor by grouping since there are four unlike terms.

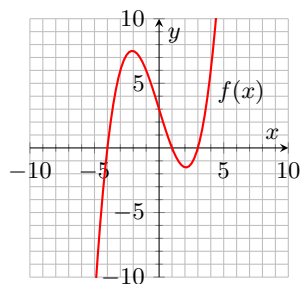
$$-x^2(3x-1) + 25(3x-1) = 0$$

3. Factor and solve for each factor.

$$\begin{aligned}(3x-1)(25-x^2) &= 0 \\ (3x-1)(5-x)(5+x) &= 0 \\ \Rightarrow x &= 1/3, -5, 5\end{aligned}$$

Find the x and y intercepts from a graph.

- Find all the times the graph intersects the x -axis. These are your x -intercepts.
- Find all the times the graph intersects the y -axis. These are your y -intercepts.
ex.



Find the Domain and the Range.

1. Domain = x 's; Range = y 's.
2. From a table or list, just find the x 's and y 's. ex.

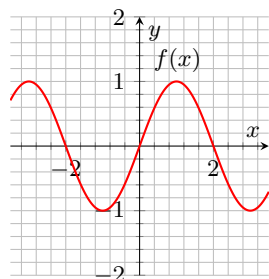
$$\{(1, 2), (0, 3), (-1, 4), (-2, 5)\}$$

$$\text{domain} = \{1, 0, -1, -2\}$$

$$\text{range} = \{2, 3, 4, 5\}$$

3. From a graph, look at the horizontal values for the domain (x 's) and the vertical values for the range (y 's). If they appear to go off the graph, then use $\pm\infty$.

ex.



Determine if the relation is a function. ex. $\{(1, -2), (2, -1), (2, 0), (3, 1)\}$

1. Check that each x , in (x, y) , is paired with only one y value.

$$1 \rightarrow -2$$

$$2 \rightarrow -1$$

$$2 \rightarrow 0$$

$$3 \rightarrow 1$$

2. If any x is paired with two different y 's then the relation is NOT a function.

$$2 \rightarrow -1$$

$$2 \rightarrow 0$$

So this is NOT a function.

3. Be suspicious if an x appears more than once.

Find the slope passing through the given points. ex, (1, 3) and (0, 5)

1. Use the formula, $m = \frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1}$. Identify (x_1, y_1) and (x_2, y_2) .

$$x_1 = 1, y_1 = 3 \text{ and } x_2 = 0, y_2 = 5$$

2. Plug the values into the formula.

$$m = \frac{5 - 3}{0 - 1} = \frac{2}{-1} = -2$$

Use the information to write an equation for the line in point-slope and slope-intercept form. ex. Slope of -2 , passing through $(1, 3)$.

1. Find the slope: Use the formula, $y - y_1 = m(x - x_1)$. Identify m , x_1 , and y_1 .

The slope is $m = -2$, and the point gives $x_1 = 1$ and $y_1 = 3$.

2. Plug the values into the formula.

$$y - 3 = -2(x - 1) \text{ point-slope form}$$

3. Solve for y to get $y = mx + b$.

$$y = -2x + 2 + 3$$

$$y = -2x + 5 \text{ slope-intercept form}$$

Use the information to write an equation for the line in point-slope and slope-intercept form. ex. The line perpendicular to $y = -1/4x + 2$ and passing through the point $(1, -1)$.

1. Find the slope: $m = -(-1/4) = 1/4$.

It is perpendicular so take the negative reciprocal. (If it was parallel we would just take the slope, $m = -1/4$).

2. Plug the values into the formula.

$$y - (-1) = 1/4(x - 1) \Rightarrow y + 1 = 1/4(x - 1) \text{ point-slope form.}$$

3. Solve for y to get $y = mx + b$.

$$y = 1/4x - 1/4 - 1$$

$$y = 1/4x - 5/4 \text{ slope-intercept form}$$

Evaluate a function at a given value. ex. $f(x) = 3x^2 - x$ find $f(-2)$ and $f(x + 1)$.

1. Plug the given value where there is an x .

$$\begin{aligned} f(-2) &= 3(-2)^2 - (-2) \\ &= 3 \cdot 4 + 2 = 14 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} f(x + 1) &= 3(x + 1)^2 - (x + 1) \\ &= 3(x^2 + 2x + 1) - x - 1 \\ &= 3x^2 + 5x + 2 \end{aligned}$$

Determine if a function is even, odd, or neither. ex $f(x) = 3x^2 - x$, $g(x) = 5x^3 - x$, and $h(x) = 4x^2 - 4$.

Look at the graph to check symmetry or check algebraically.

$f(x)$ is neither since $3x^2$ is even but $-x$ is odd.

$g(x)$ is odd and $h(x)$ is even since each term is odd and even respectively.